

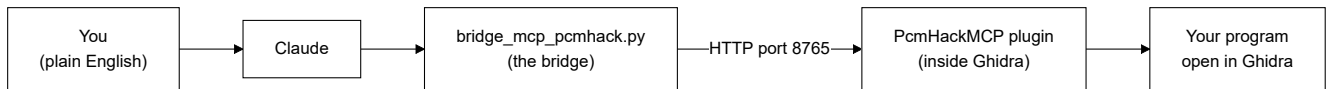
PcmHackMCP Setup Manual

This guide takes you from nothing to a working setup where you can ask **Claude** to drive **Ghidra** in plain English - decompiling code, renaming things, and running Python scripts inside Ghidra automatically.

What you are setting up

"MCP" (Model Context Protocol) is just a standard way for an AI assistant to use an external tool. PcmHackMCP connects Claude to Ghidra. There are three pieces, and this manual installs all three:

1. **The Ghidra extension** (`PcmHackMCP-11.3.2.zip`) - a plugin that runs *inside* Ghidra and starts a small web server on your PC at port **8765**.
2. **The bridge** (`bridge_mcp_pcmhack.py`) - a small Python program that Claude launches; it passes Claude's requests to the Ghidra extension.
3. **Claude** - the assistant you talk to (the **Claude Desktop** app and/or **Claude Code**).



When everything is connected, you can type things like *"list every function whose name starts with FUN_"* or *"run a Python script that renames these 200 addresses"*, and Claude carries it out in Ghidra.

Before you start (prerequisites)

Install these first. If you already have them, skip ahead.

1. Ghidra 11.3.2 (and Java)

Ghidra needs **Java (JDK) 17 or 21**. The free **Eclipse Temurin JDK 21** works well.

- JDK 21: <https://adoptium.net> - download "Temurin 21 (LTS)", run the installer, accept the defaults.
- Ghidra 11.3.2: <https://github.com/NationalSecurityAgency/ghidra/releases> - download `ghidra_11.3.2_PUBLIC_*.zip`, then **extract** it to a folder you will keep (for example `C:\Tools\Ghidra\ghidra_11.3.2_PUBLIC`). Ghidra does not have an installer; you run it from the extracted folder by double-clicking `ghidraRun.bat`.

This manual targets **Ghidra 11.3.2 exactly**. The extension is built for that version and will be refused by other versions.

2. Python 3

- Download from <https://www.python.org/downloads/> and run the installer.
- On the first installer screen, **tick "Add python.exe to PATH"** and leave the **"py launcher"** option ticked. This gives you the `py` command used below.

3. Claude

- **Claude Desktop** (recommended for beginners): <https://claude.ai/download>. Install and sign in.
- **Claude Code** (optional, command-line): a terminal tool for power users. If you have it, this manual covers it too.

4. Python packages the bridge needs

Open **Command Prompt** (press the Windows key, type `cmd`, press Enter) and run:

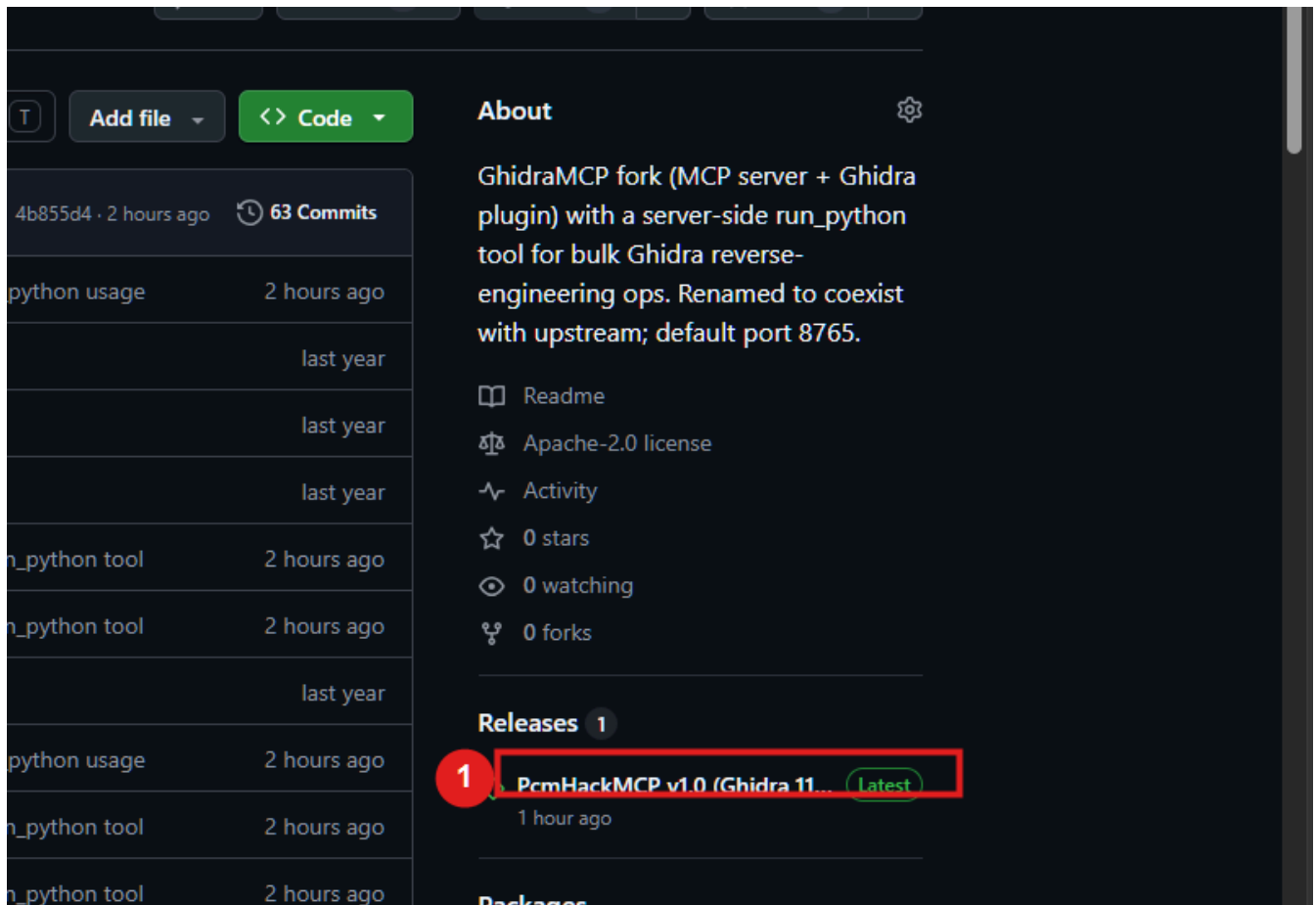
```
py -3 -m pip install mcp requests
```

This installs the two libraries the bridge uses. You only do this once.

Step 1 - Download the files from GitHub

Go to the project page: <https://github.com/hjtrbo/PcmHackMCP>

On the right-hand side, under **Releases**, click the latest release.



Click the release listed under "Releases" (1).

On the release page, under **Assets**, download **both** files by clicking each one:



Download `bridge_mcp_pcmhack.py` (1) and `PcmHackMCP-11.3.2.zip` (2). They land in your Downloads folder.

- `PcmHackMCP-11.3.2.zip` - the Ghidra extension (do **not** unzip it; Ghidra wants the zip).
- `bridge_mcp_pcmhack.py` - the bridge Claude will run.

Step 2 - Put the bridge in a permanent folder

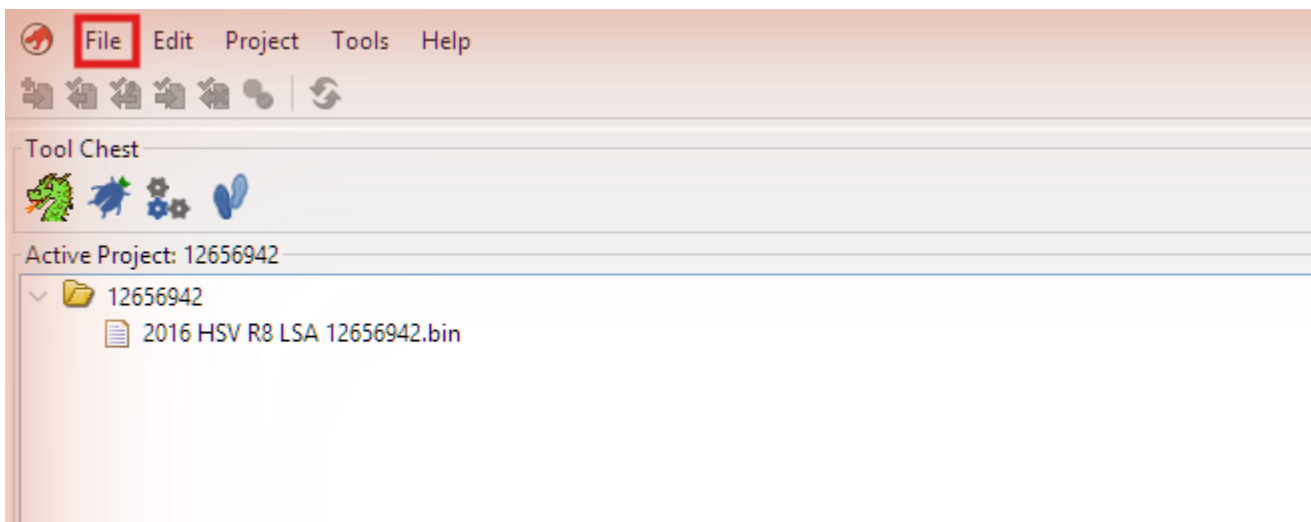
The bridge is a shared tool used by every project, so keep it somewhere stable - not in a project folder or in OneDrive.

1. Create the folder `C:\Tools\PcmHackMCP`.
2. Move `bridge_mcp_pcmhack.py` from Downloads into `C:\Tools\PcmHackMCP`.

You will point Claude at `C:\Tools\PcmHackMCP\bridge_mcp_pcmhack.py` later, so it is important this path does not change afterwards.

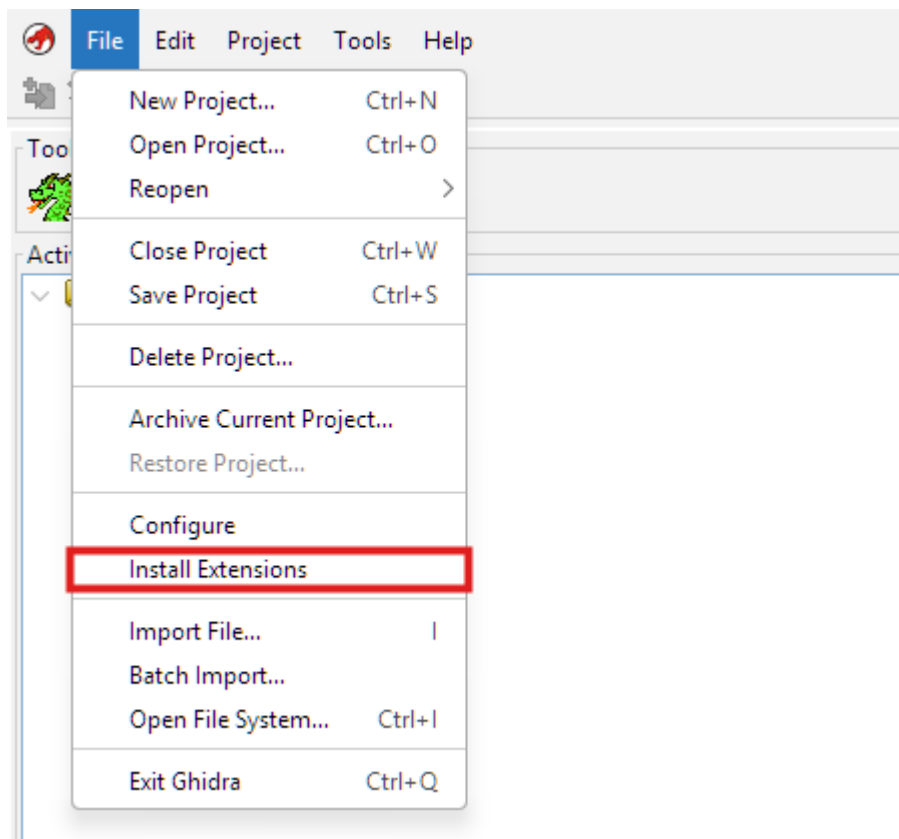
Step 3 - Install the extension in Ghidra

Start Ghidra (double-click `ghidraRun.bat`). You will see the **project window**.



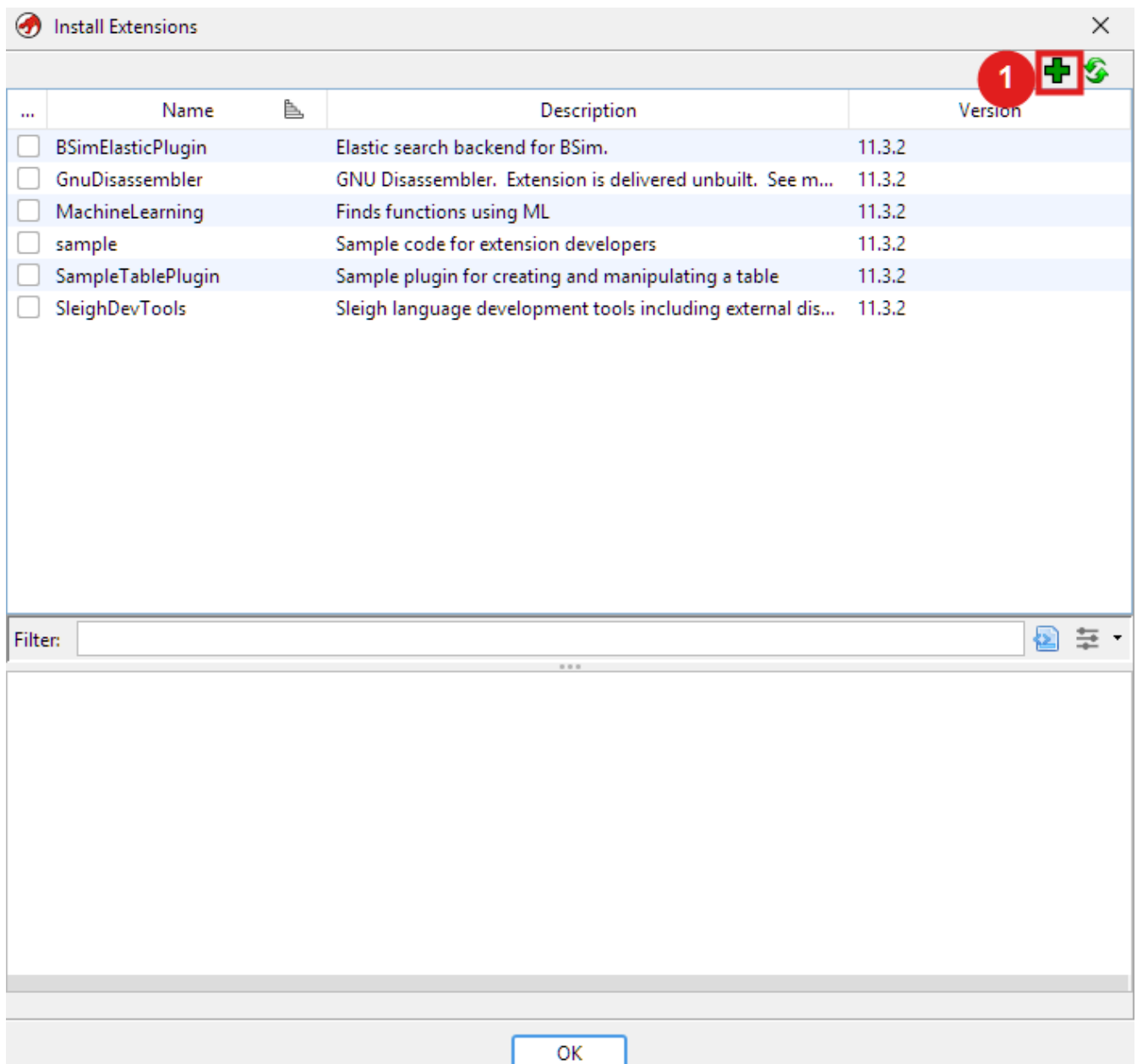
The Ghidra project window. Click the File menu (red box).

Open the **File** menu and choose **Install Extensions**.



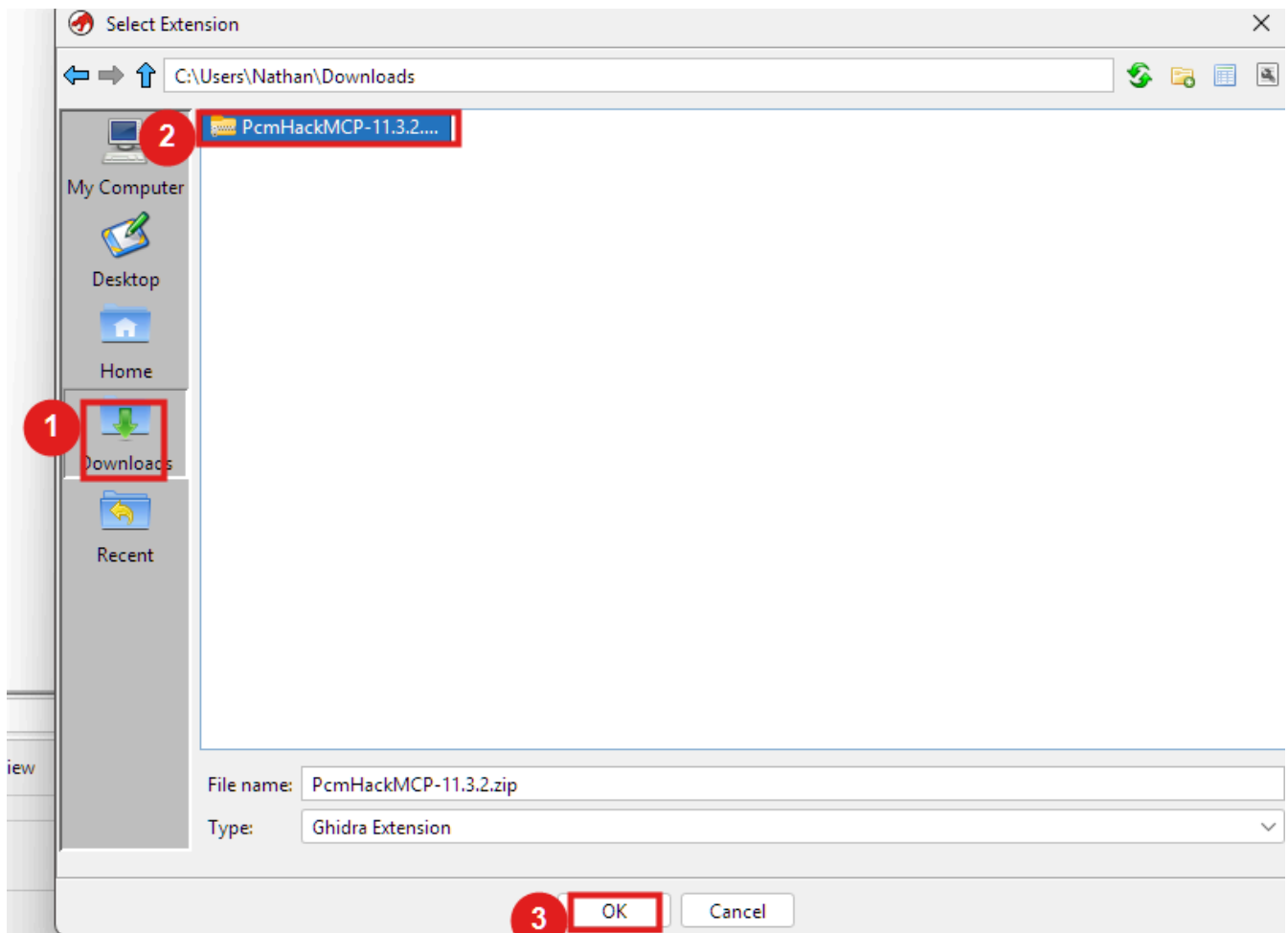
File menu - click Install Extensions.

In the Install Extensions window, click the green + button (top-right).



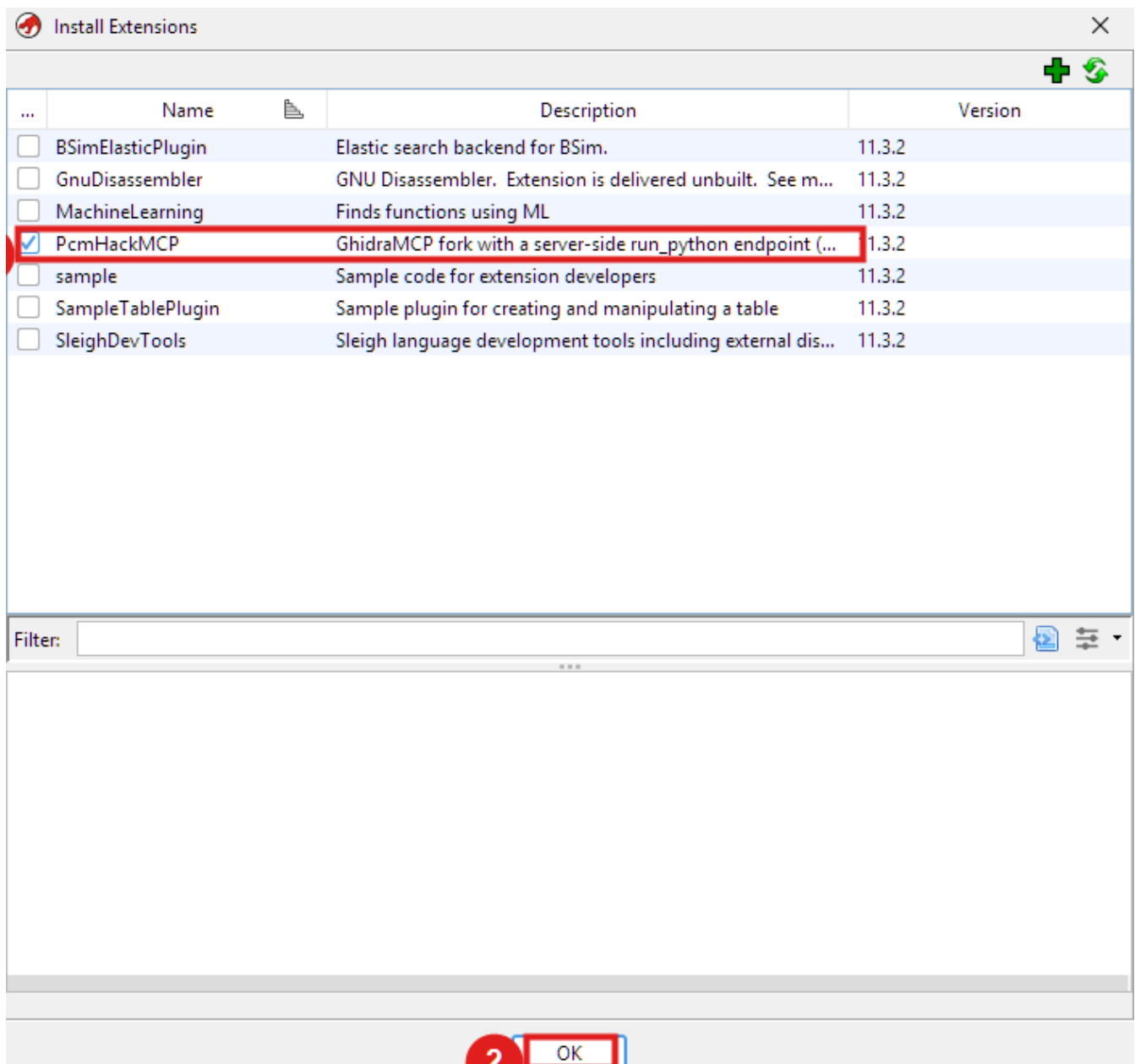
Click the green + to add an extension from a file (1).

A file chooser opens. On the left, click **Downloads** (1), select **PcmHackMCP-11.3.2.zip** (2), then click **OK** (3).



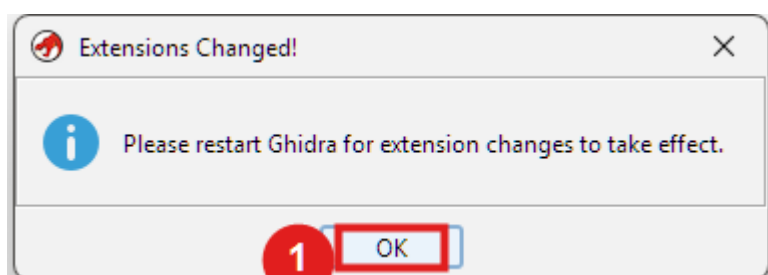
Go to Downloads (1), pick the zip (2), click OK (3).

The extension now appears in the list with its box **ticked**. Click **OK**.



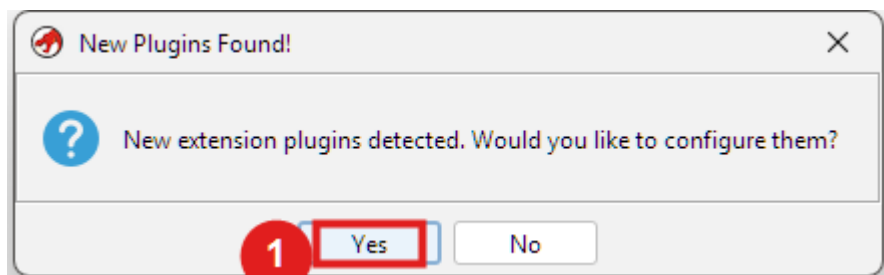
PcmHackMCP is now ticked (1). Click OK (2).

Ghidra tells you it must restart for the change to take effect. Click **OK**, then **close Ghidra and start it again** (double-click *ghidraRun.bat*).



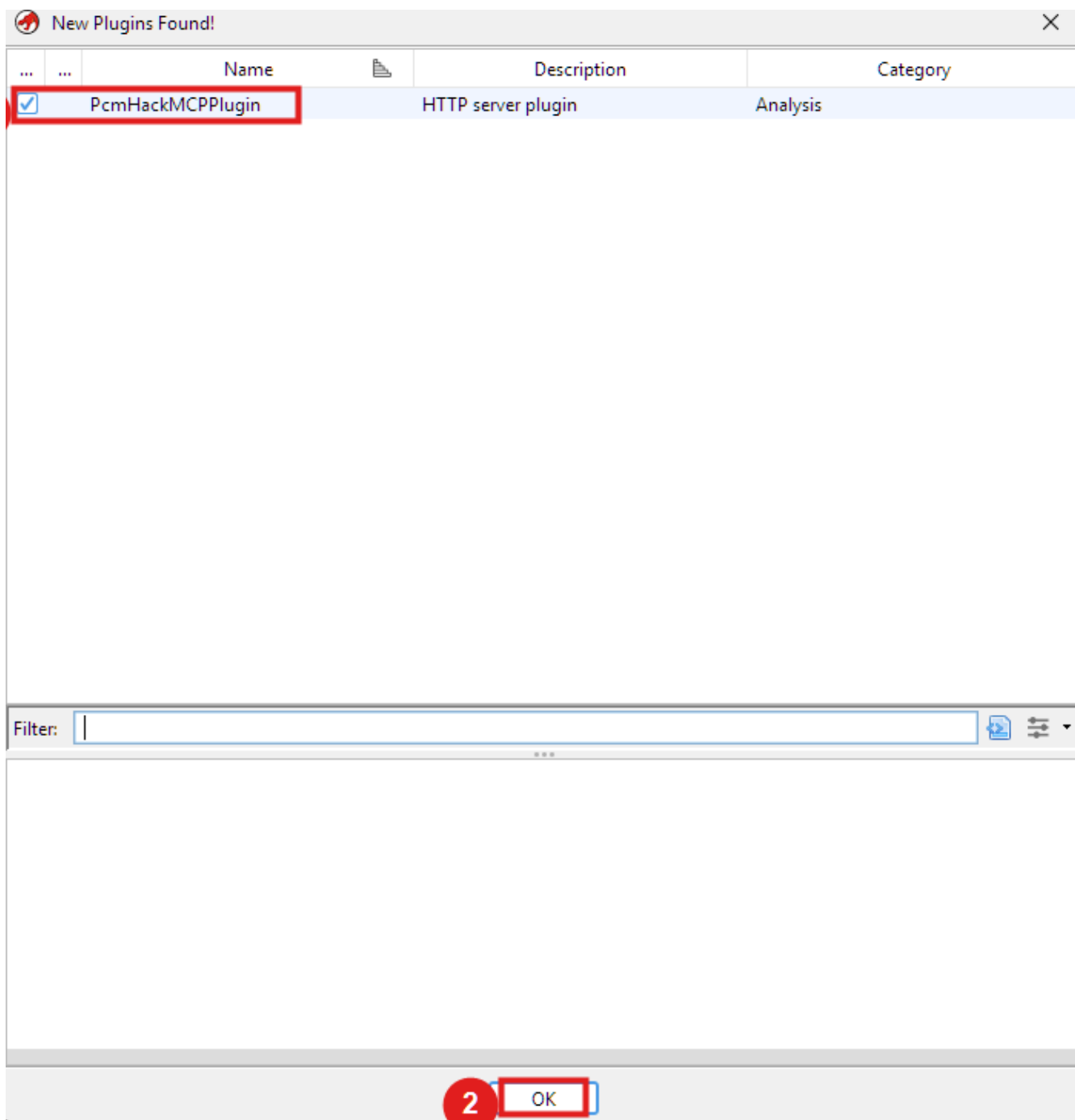
Click OK (1), then fully restart Ghidra.

After restarting, **open a program** in your project (double-click it). Because the extension is new, Ghidra asks if you want to configure it. Click **Yes**.



Click Yes (1) to configure the new plugin.

Make sure **PcmHackMCPPPlugin** is ticked, then click **OK**.



Confirm `PcmHackMCPPlugin` is ticked (1), click OK (2).

That is it for Ghidra. The plugin is now running a web server on your PC at **port 8765**, ready for Claude. Leave Ghidra open whenever you want to use PcmHackMCP.

Tip: Ghidra copies the extension into its own folder during install (under `AppData\Roaming\ghidra\ghidra_11.3.2_PUBLIC\Extensions\`), so once it is installed you can delete `PcmHackMCP-11.3.2.zip` from your Downloads folder if you like - the extension keeps working.

Step 4 - Register with Claude Code (command line)

Skip this step if you only use Claude Desktop; go to Step 5.

Open Command Prompt and run this single command (it tells Claude Code how to launch the bridge):

```
claude mcp add pcmhack -s user -- py -3 "C:\Tools\PcmHackMCP\bridge_mcp_pcmhack.py"
```

Check it worked:

```
claude mcp list
```

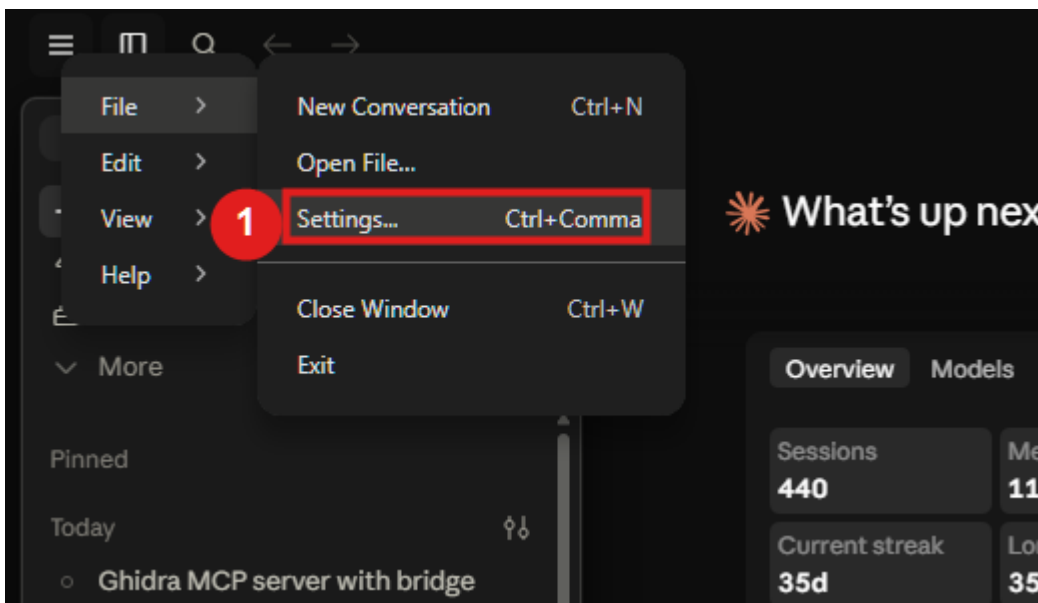
You should see:

```
pcmhack: py -3 C:\Tools\PcmHackMCP\bridge_mcp_pcmhack.py - Connected
```

Connected means Claude Code can talk to the bridge. New Claude Code sessions will now have the PcmHackMCP tools.

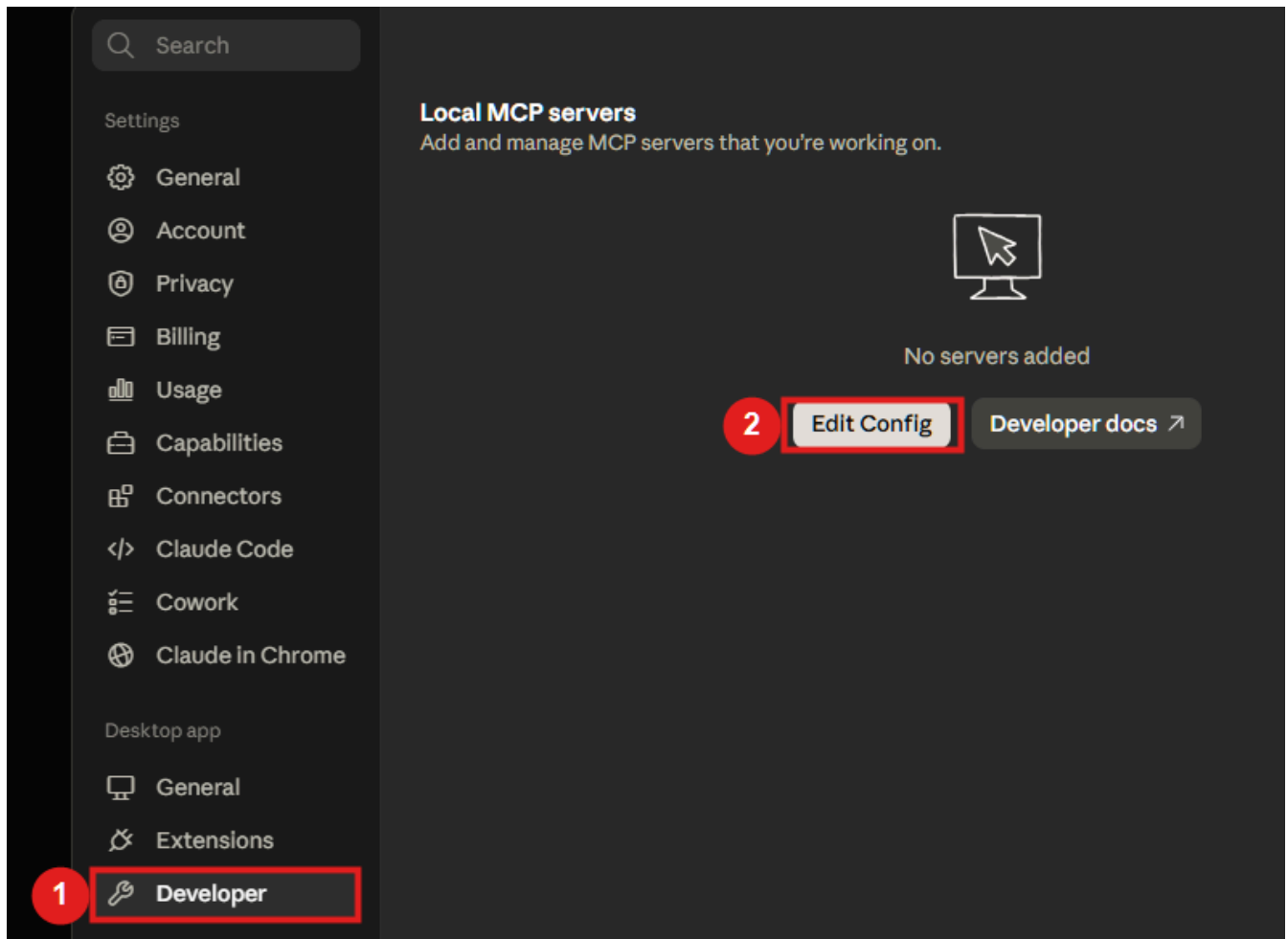
Step 5 - Register with Claude Desktop

Open **Claude Desktop**. Open the **File** menu and choose **Settings**.



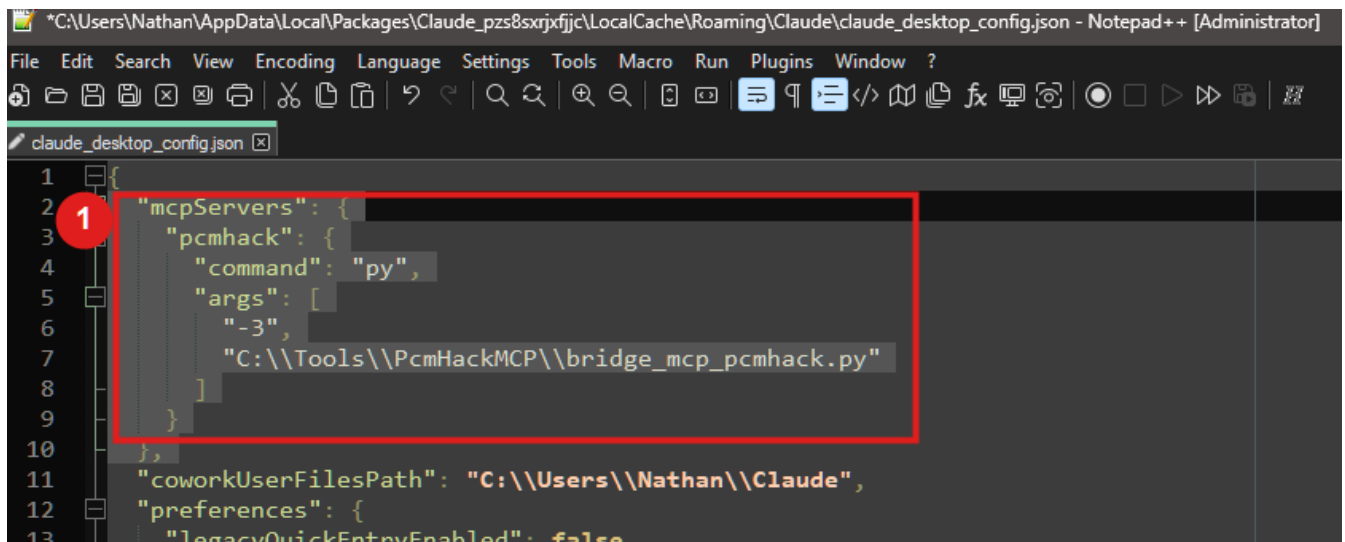
File menu - click Settings (1).

In Settings, scroll the left list to **Developer** (under "Desktop app") and click it, then click **Edit Config**.



Click Developer (1), then Edit Config (2). It opens `claude_desktop_config.json` in a text editor.

Add the `mcpServers` block shown below. If the file already has content (such as `coworkUserFilesPath` or `preferences`), keep it and just add `mcpServers` as another top-level entry, separated by a comma.



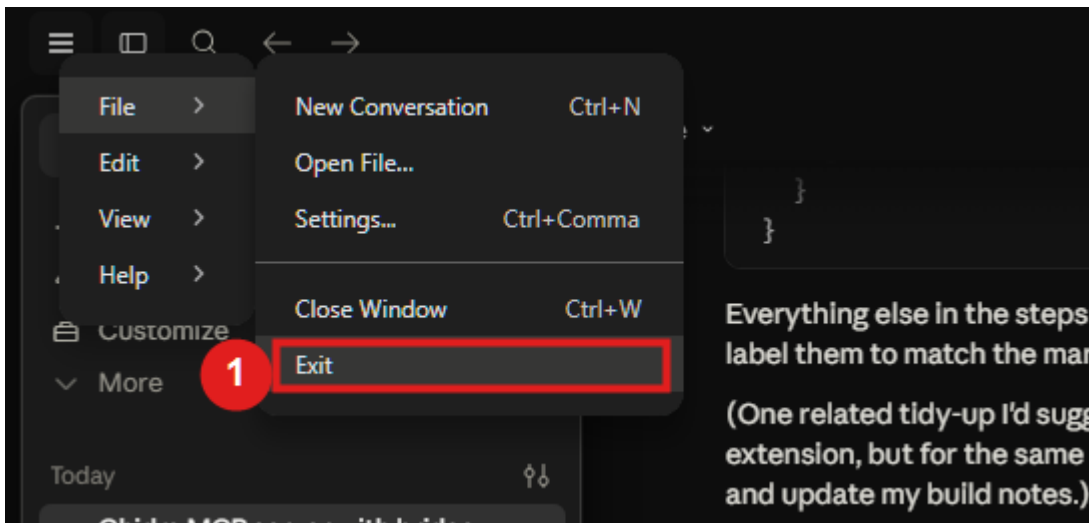
The `mcpServers` / `pcmhack` block added to the config (1). The title bar shows where the file lives.

The block to add:

```
"mcpServers": {
  "pcmhack": {
    "command": "py",
    "args": [
      "-3",
      "C:\\\\Tools\\\\PcmHackMCP\\\\bridge_mcp_pcmhack.py"
    ]
  }
}
```

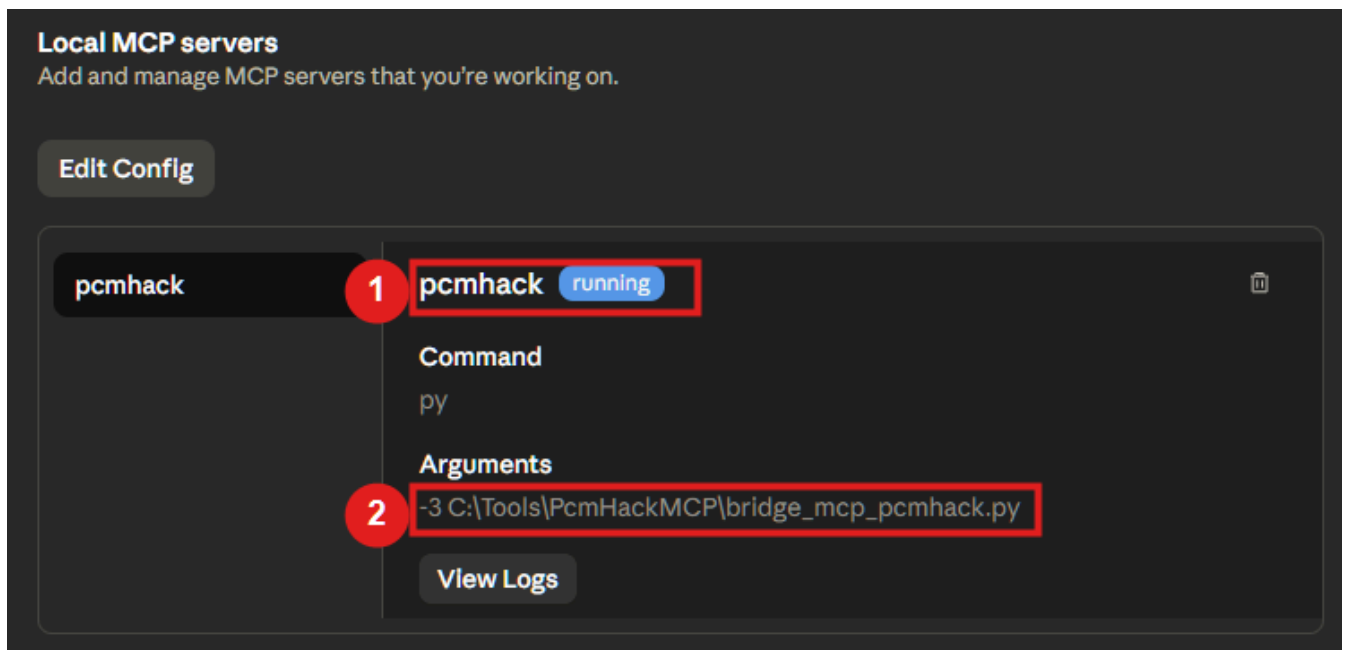
Note the **double backslashes** (\\) in the path - JSON requires them. Save the file when done (Ctrl+S).

Now **fully quit** Claude Desktop so it reloads the config. This matters: clicking the window **X** **only hides the window**; the app keeps running and will **not** reload. Use the **File menu -> Exit** instead.



Use File -> Exit (1) for a true restart. The X button does not reload the config.

Reopen Claude Desktop, go back to **Settings -> Developer**, and you should see **pcmhack** with a blue **running** badge.



Success: `pcmhack` shows running (1), launching `py -3 C:\Tools\PcmHackMCP\bridge_mcp_pcmhack.py` (2).

Step 6 - Check it works

1. Make sure **Ghidra** is open with a program loaded (the web server only runs while Ghidra is open).
2. In Claude (Desktop or Code), start a chat and ask something simple, for example:

List the first 10 functions in the program.

Claude will use the `list_functions` tool and reply with names from your Ghidra program. If you get a reply, the whole chain is working.

To run a Python script inside Ghidra, ask Claude to use `run_python`, for example:

Use `run_python` to print how many functions start with "FUN_".

The script runs inside Ghidra and Claude shows you the result.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
Ghidra says "Unexpected error installing extension"	The zip is corrupt or was re-zipped with the wrong tool. Re-download <code>PcmHackMCP-11.3.2.zip</code> from the release and install that exact file (do not unzip and re-zip it).
Extension does not appear after install	You must restart Ghidra after installing, then open a program and click Yes on the "New Plugins Found" prompt.
Claude says "No program loaded"	Open a program in Ghidra (double-click it in the project). The tools need a program open.
Claude cannot reach the server / tools time out	Ghidra must be open and running . The server lives at <code>http://127.0.0.1:8765/</code> .
Claude Desktop still shows no servers after editing the config	You did not fully restart it. Use File -> Exit (not the X), then reopen.
<code>claude mcp list</code> shows Failed	Check Python is installed (<code>py -3 --version</code>) and that you ran <code>py -3 -m pip install mcp requests</code> . Confirm the bridge path in the command is exactly <code>C:\Tools\PcmHackMCP\bridge_mcp_pcmhack.py</code> .

Reference

- **Extension (Ghidra side):** installed via Ghidra > File > Install Extensions. Starts an HTTP server on **port 8765**.
- **Bridge (Claude side):** `C:\Tools\PcmHackMCP\bridge_mcp_pcmhack.py` . Run by Claude; talks to the extension on 8765.
- **Claude Desktop config file:** `... \AppData\Local\Packages\Claude_*\LocalCache\Roaming\Claude\claude_desktop_config.json` (opened for you by **Edit Config**).
- **Claude Code registry:** `C:\Users\<you>\.claude.json` (written by `claude mcp add`).
- **Project page / updates:** <https://github.com/hjtrbo/PcmHackMCP>
- **Security note:** the server accepts connections and `run_python` runs arbitrary code on your PC. Only use it on a trusted network.